

BANARAS HINDU UNIVERSITY

B.Com. (Hons.) — Semester I Examination, 2022-23

Paper No. BCHE-111: English Language

Time: 3 Hours

Maximum Marks: 70

Instructions: The figures on the right indicate full marks for the concerned question. Answer All Sections.

SECTION – A**Question 1.** Answer any *two* of the following: [20]

- (a) You are the purchase manager of a well-established IT firm. You need to procure 20 computers for a new project to be started immediately. Write an 'enquiry letter' to a reputed computer shop named Zenith requesting to provide a detailed quotation. You may specify your special requirements in the letter.
- (b) Write a 'letter of quotation' as the manager of sales department of Zenith to the letter mentioned in Question 1(a) above. Mention the cost of packing and transport etc. that will be over and above the MRP. Provide a time period within which you will be able to execute the order.
- (c) Write a 'letter of order' as the manager of the IT firm mentioned in Question 1(a) and in response to the quotation that you received from sales manager of Zenith. Make a few changes in the requirements that you had mentioned and request for a discount as you will continue to be a client of Zenith.

Question 2. Answer any *one* of the following: [10]

- (a) Write a letter to the municipal authorities about the faulty streetlights in your residential colony citing the difficulties faced by the inhabitants. Make a request in the letter to repair the streetlights.
 - (b) Write a news report about the programs that were organized by the students of the Faculty of Commerce as part of the Annual Arts Festival.
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SECTION – B

Question 3. Write a précis for the following paragraph in not more than 65 words and provide an appropriate title for your précis: [10]

The single, decisive factor that made it possible for humankind to settle in permanent communities was agriculture. A turning point in human history, the invention of farming and the tremendous changes it brought about have been called the agricultural revolution. After farming was developed in the Middle East about 6500 BC, people living in tribes or family units did not have to be on the move continually searching for food or herding their animals. Once people could control the production of food and be assured of a reliable annual supply of it, their lives changed completely.

People began to found permanent communities in fertile river valleys. They settled around rivers for several reasons. Rivers were an important source of fresh water for drinking. They could be used for transportation. Settlers also learned to use the water supply to irrigate the land for farming. Sedentary settlement, or being settled in one place, made it possible to domesticate animals in order to provide other sources of food and clothing.

Farming was indeed a revolutionary discovery. It not only made settlements possible - and ultimately the building of cities - but it also made available a reliable food supply. With more food available, more people could be fed. Populations therefore increased. The growing number of people available for more kinds of work led to the development of more complex social structures. With a food surplus, a community could support a variety of workers who were not farmers. The agricultural revolution thus resulted in a division of labour, with some people farming, while others worked at various crafts, such as making pottery, cloth, or tools. Craftspeople traded the goods they made to farmers for food.

All the major ancient civilizations - in Mesopotamia, Egypt, the Indus valley, and China - emerged in the 4th millennium BC. Historians still debate over which one emerged first. It may well have been in the Middle East, in an area called the Fertile Crescent. This area stretches from the Nile River in Egypt northward along the coast of the historical region of Palestine, then eastward into Asia to include Mesopotamia. In this area people settled along the riverbanks and practiced field agriculture. This kind of farming depended on the reproduction of seed, normally from grain crops.

Question 4. Answer the following questions as per the instructions in the brackets: [10]

- (a) The old man was taken to the hospital by somebody. (*Change the sentence into active voice*)
- (b) I _____ (*read*) this book many times before. (*Fill in the blank with correct tense form of the verb given in the brackets*)
- (c) He appears to be _____ honest and intelligent man. (*Use appropriate article*)
- (d) Varanasi is famous for _____ Ganges and the ghats. (*Use appropriate article*)
- (e) He came _____ the room without permission. (*Use appropriate preposition*)
- (f) He is the person _____ I met yesterday at the lunch. (*Use appropriate relative pronoun*)

- (g) We see many people displaced due to war these days. Such _____ causes extreme suffering for them. (*Fill in the blank with appropriate form of the word in italics*)
- (h) He *elaborated* all the points well. His _____ of the argument was approved by the panel. (*Fill in the blank with appropriate form of the word in italics*)
- (i) We must *accept* hardships in life. Such _____ will bring us satisfaction eventually. (*Fill in the blank with appropriate form of the word in italics*)
- (j) When I returned home, I _____ (found/had found/find) the house broken into. (*Choose the correct tense form of the verb given in the brackets*)
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Question 5. Explain the below quoted lines with proper reference and context in approximately 200 words: [10]

- (a) “To be able to read any language, Hindi or Urdu or English, you have to learn its alphabet. So also you must learn the alphabet of nature before you can read her story in her books of stone and rock. Even now perhaps you know a little how to read this.”

OR

“He was always a model prisoner because he believed in sticking to the rules. But he was a very clever chap and very good at producing some reason why the rules could be bent. You never had much trouble except that if there was something that he could not agree with and he couldn’t get his way, a hunger strike was threatened. And nobody wanted that.”

- (b) “Without Thee what is all the morning’s wealth ?
Come, blessed barrier between day and day,
Dear mother of fresh thoughts and joyous health !”

OR

“May the sum of evil
balanced in this unreal world
against the sum of good
become diminished by your pain.”

SECTION – C

Question 6. Answer any *five* of the following questions in a sentence or two each: [10]

- (a) “About what time do you think I’m going to die?” Why did Schatz ask this question?
- (b) Jesse Owens felt a hand on his shoulder. Whose hand was this and what did it signify?
- (c) What two things did Washington do to save enough money to travel to the new school?
- (d) What ideas do the lily and the oak stand for in the poem “The Noble Nature”?
- (e) How did Patrick Quin come to know that the rest of the European prisoners were in touch with Gandhi?
- (f) Why does the poet describe the poison of scorpion as “flash of diabolic tail” in the poem “Night of the Scorpion”?
- (g) Whose efforts were responsible for the revival of the Olympic Games in the year 1896?

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